James Praise

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Marketing leader who has built and run marketing functions for SaaS and B2B companies since 2018, across Africa, North America and Europe. I set the positioning, build the acquisition and lifecycle programs, lead the people and agencies behind them, and report against revenue. I have repositioned a product for a new buyer, moved most of a free user base onto paid plans, and run sales and marketing as one revenue team as a Chief Revenue Officer. I have also worked both sides of creator marketing: I built an affiliate program on PartnerStack, and I run a newsletter that sells sponsored product showcases. More at jamespraise.xyz/work/modash.

Selected Achievements:

- Repositioned Reform around lead conversion: **34% lift in trial activation** and **19% more decision-stage leads** from competitor pages. Moved **72% of legacy freemium users** onto paid plans through a phased sunset.
- Generated **1,331 marketing qualified leads in six months** as Head of Growth and Marketing at Bujeti (YC W23). New B2B customers grew **500% in Q1 2024**, and lifecycle redesign cut churn by **10%**.
- Rose from Sales Manager to **Chief Revenue Officer** at Cecure Intelligence Limited and ran cross-functional GTM teams: **1,646 marketing qualified leads, 629 demos and $3.4M in open deal value**.
- Won back **8% of cancelled paid subscribers** at Reform, and **75%** were still paying 90 days later.
- Grew the Marketing In Action newsletter to **5,000+ subscribers at a 47% average open rate**, and sold sponsored product showcases to software companies. Named one of Africa's Top 20 Marketing Leaders (APMP 2025).

KEY SKILLS

Strategy: Positioning & Messaging, Upmarket & Enterprise Positioning, Cross-Sell & Expansion Programs, Go-to-Market & Launch Planning, Marketing Planning & Budget Allocation, Competitive Intelligence, Customer Research

Execution: Product Marketing, Lifecycle & Retention, SEO & Content, Creator, Affiliate & Partner Programs, Paid Social & Search, Sales & Marketing Alignment, Attribution & Revenue Reporting, Team & Agency Leadership

Tools: GA4, Looker Studio, Google Tag Manager, HubSpot, Mixpanel, Meta & TikTok Ads, Google Ads, PartnerStack, Brevo, Webflow, Claude Code, n8n

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder | Marketing In Action | Apr 2024 – Present
Marketing In Action (newsletter, academy and marketing services, Nigeria, US, UK)

- Grew the newsletter to 5,000+ subscribers at a 47% average open rate, and run its sponsored product showcases for software companies.
- Run a paid-ads services business with three specialists, who deliver client work through a documented handoff, review and reporting system.
- Built a paid-acquisition system that judges campaigns on backend sales instead of ad-platform reports. It caught Meta cross-crediting sales between products.

Product Marketing Manager | Reform | Feb 2024 – Apr 2026
Reform (SaaS, MarTech, conversion-focused form builder, acquired by FunnelEnvy)

- Repositioned the product around lead conversion: 34% lift in trial activation and 19% more decision-stage leads from competitor pages.
- Ran the freemium sunset that moved 72% of legacy free users onto paid plans, and a win-back program that reactivated 8% of cancelled subscribers.
- Launched the Pro Plan free trial across web, email and in-app: 21% lift in trial-to-paid conversion.
- Built the feature launch framework that lifted new feature adoption 26% within 90 days.
- Built Reform's affiliate partner program on PartnerStack from scratch: recruiting, incentives, tracking and swipe assets.

GTM Lead | FunnelEnvy | Feb 2024 – Apr 2026
FunnelEnvy (B2B, revenue funnel optimization service provider)

- Built a quarterly demand generation roadmap across outbound, lifecycle and paid: 40% quarter-over-quarter lift in qualified enterprise leads.
- Led the FunnelEnvy rebrand: visual identity, brand style guide and sales deck system. Managed an outsourced content agency.
- Designed a cross-brand measurement stack (GA4, Looker Studio, Lightdash, HubSpot) that cut reporting time 50%.

Head of Inbound Marketing & SEO | Distrobird | Feb 2024 – Apr 2024
Distrobird (sales engagement SaaS, US)

- Led a content team of five writers and two editors and ranked for 3,000+ competitive keywords in three months.

Head of Growth & Marketing | Bujeti | Sep 2023 – Feb 2024
Bujeti (YC W23, SaaS, fintech spend and expense management, Nigeria)

- Built the growth function across product marketing, lifecycle, SEO, events and partnerships.
- Generated 1,331 marketing qualified leads in six months and grew new B2B customers 500% in Q1 2024.
- Redesigned lifecycle email and in-app flows: 20% higher engagement and 10% lower churn.

Chief Revenue Officer | Cecure Intelligence Limited | Jun 2022 – Sep 2023
Cecure Intelligence Limited (B2B technology and training provider, UK and Sub-Saharan Africa)

- Progressed from Sales Manager to Head of Growth & Marketing to Chief Revenue Officer, running revenue operations and cross-functional GTM teams.
- Generated 1,646 marketing qualified leads, 406 sales qualified leads and 629 demos: $326K in sales velocity and $3.4M in open deal value.
- Launched the CIL Academy across Nigeria, Ghana, Kenya, Rwanda and Angola: 20,000+ community members and 10,000+ users in the first cohort.
- Ran influencer and creator partnerships as part of the acquisition mix, alongside partnerships with AWS, Google and Microsoft.

Marketing, Growth & GTM Roles | Multiple Companies | 2018 – 2022
B2B, SaaS, fintech, consumer brands and service businesses

- Product Marketing Manager at Bento Africa (payroll and HR fintech across four countries): 50% more sales qualified leads and 25% higher sales conversion from lead scoring and lifecycle nurture.
- Marketing & Growth Advisor at JegzFits Leatherworks (consumer brand, Nigeria, 2021 to present): Meta and TikTok acquisition at about 8x return on ad spend over five years.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- **MBA, Entrepreneurship & Innovation** | Miva Open University (2026) | CGPA: 4.92/5.0
- **Product Marketing PMMC™ Certification** | Product Marketing Alliance (2025)
- **Outbound Automation & AI GTM Engineering Certification** | Clay (2025)
- **BSc. Biochemistry** | University of Lagos (2018) | CGPA: 4.46/5.0